10. The image of a heavily fortified landscape and also Ghuris' specialization in special armaments (see below in main text) emerged already from Baihaqi's descriptions (trans. Bosworth), vol. I, 2011: 199–204, vol. III: 97–98 (note 446 to AH 421/1030 CE).
11. Cf. Bosworth (1961: 118, 124; Bosworth [1977] 1992: 68), who cited Ya'qut, and relied largely on Marquart's observations, in turn gleaned from al-Biruni.
12. Mahmud 2009: esp. 242ff.
13. Mahmud 2009: esp. 251–254; also Hunter 2010: 82. See Patel 2017 for the historiographical context and analysis of Mahmud's monograph. The historical texts' frequent mention of the Ghuris' arms manufacture further underscores their undoubtedly symbiotic relationship with settled society, echoing Gellner's observations above. See also Thomas and Gascoigne 2016: 174ff.; Thomas 2018.
14. See O'Neal 2015; O'Neal 2016a. Ghafur (1960: 1–12) also provided an overview of the contemporary and later textual sources with information on the Shansabanis, though adopting Barthold's (1968: 30) characterizations of "the second half of the 12th and the beginning of the 13th century [as] one of the darkest pages of Muslim history," and the text-based data as contradictory and requiring "very critical study" (borne out by Bosworth 1977/1992: 115ff.). Ghafur's useful survey of the contemporary works, including those unfortunately lost and known only through later authors' citations, encompassed both the chronicles patronized by other courts and containing some mention of the Shansabanis (e.g., al-Rawandi's *Rahat al-Sudur wa Ayat al-Surur*, *c.* 1205, principally focused on the Saljuqs), and those written within the Shansabani courts themselves, such as Fakhr al-Din Razi's *Risala-yi Bahaiyya* (see also Chapter 3), dedicated to the Bamiyan ruler Baha' al-Din Sam (r. 1192–1206) (cf. *infra* in main text). However, given the evident participation of the non-extant works and their authors in the Persianate literary world and its conventions of poetry and prose – an assumption bolstered by the *surviving* texts – it is practically certain that the overall corpus offered little more data, perhaps only allusions to the Shansabanis' pre-imperial nomadic ancestors and lifeways.
15. See Asif 2016: 51–55, 57–60; Anooshahr 2018b: 2–3.
16. I borrow the phrasing from Anooshahr (2018b: 2 and n. 3), whose work focused on the fifteenth- and sixteenth-century emergence of the great Eurasian empires of the Ottomans, Safavids, and Mughals. Anooshahr's incisive analyses of the crafting of their identities also informs parallel processes in the tenth–twelfth-century period of nomadic confederacies coming to rule large swaths of the Islamic world, most notably the Saljuqs. See also, *inter alia*, Bosworth 1968a: 40–41; Bosworth 1973: 61–62; Meisami 1993; and Chapter 3.
17. See Bosworth 1973: 55 and *passim*; esp. Meisami 1999: 20–21, 37–45; also Peacock 2018: 4ff.
18. Cf. Bosworth 1961: 125–126 and n. 32. The transformation of Zahhak from the tyrant and sinner of canonical texts – such as al-Ghazali's (d. AH 504/1111 CE) *Nasihat al-muluk* (cf. Lambton 1981/2006: 122–123) – to a desirable ancestral figure perhaps best demonstrated the great epistemological/conceptual